

OUTLIERS

Judgement

Layer 5 of 8 · What your system cannot
work out on its own.

FOR MAC

EST. MMXXVI · OUTLIERS ACCELERATOR

Something has to weigh it up

Your system can now tell you what happened. It cannot tell you what any of it means. That needs judgement, and this is the first layer that has any.

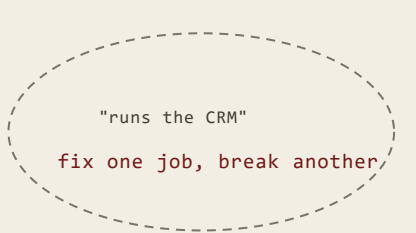
WHAT THE LAST LAYER LEFT YOU WITH

You have a history that fills itself. What you do not have is anything that reads it and forms a view. A program can tell you that somebody replied. It cannot tell you whether the reply was warm, whether the person is worth your time, or what to say next.

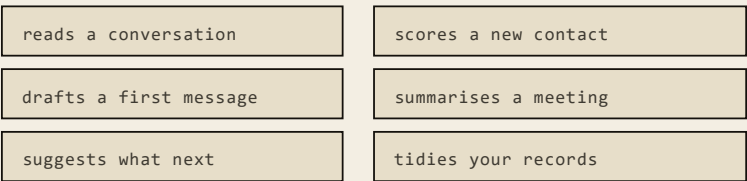
WHAT THIS LAYER BUILDS

Assistants. Each one is given a single job, its own written instructions, and permission to use particular tools and nothing else. They read what your system knows, form a view, and hand it to you.

ONE ASSISTANT DOING EVERYTHING



SEVERAL, ONE JOB EACH



each one can be tested, corrected or replaced on its own

every fact one writes down says where it came from

anything it is unsure of waits for you instead of being saved

ONE JOB EACH. TESTABLE ONE AT A TIME.

How it works

An assistant is not magic and should not be treated as such. It is a worker you briefed, and you judge it the same way.

WHAT AN ASSISTANT ACTUALLY IS

A set of written instructions handed to an AI, the same kind you would type a question into, plus one clearly defined job, plus a short list of actions it is allowed to take and nothing outside that list. That is the whole of it. The instructions are a text file you can read and change, so you can see exactly what you asked for.

JUDGE ONE THE WAY YOU WOULD JUDGE A PERSON

You already know what good and bad look like when a human does a job. If you hired someone to go through your contacts and tell you which are worth a call, you would know within 10 minutes whether they had understood. Use exactly that instinct here. If the output would annoy you coming from a person, it is not acceptable coming from an assistant either.

ONE JOB EACH, NEVER ONE BIG ONE

The tempting choice is a single assistant that does everything. It cannot be tested in parts, and correcting one behaviour changes another you never touched. Several small ones can each be checked, improved or thrown away on their own.

EVERY FACT SAYS WHERE IT CAME FROM

An assistant that is right and an assistant that has invented something produce output that looks identical. Same confidence, same tidy sentences. A week later you cannot tell which is which by reading it.

So nothing gets written into your records without saying where it came from and when. If the evidence is thin, it is not saved at all: it waits in a list for you to look at. Your records stay a record of what is true, and everything uncertain stays visibly uncertain.

Before you start on a Mac

Everything in this guide is typed into **Terminal**, the Mac's window for typing commands instead of clicking. Press Command and Space together, type Terminal, and press Return.

This layer needs Python and git, which you set up for Layer 1 (its page "Before you start on a Mac"), and the layers before this one. It installs no add-ons, so it works with either Python a Mac may have.

HOW TO TYPE THE LINES

Where this guide shows several lines in a black box, type them one at a time: type the first, press Return, wait for it to finish and give you a fresh line, then type the next. The installer asks you questions. Each offers an answer in [square brackets]; press Return to take it, or type your own and press Return.

WHERE YOUR CRM IS

Layer 1 made your CRM at ~/CRM: a folder called CRM in your home folder (the folder with your name and the house picture in Finder's sidebar). If you chose another folder in Layer 1, put your own folder wherever a line in this guide says ~/CRM. The installer finds your CRM by itself either way.

Apple Silicon or Intel (the 2 kinds of chip a Mac can have; the Apple menu, then About This Mac, shows yours): the steps are the same on both, and both were tested.

Tried only on test Macs. Every step in this guide and in the instructions file of the layer's download was tried on test Macs (Macs GitHub rents out by the minute to run a script, not a person's own Mac, and not yours), never on a real Mac, except 1: the box asking to install the developer tools, which cannot appear on a test Mac. The last pages list every line and what happened to it.

Build it

3 lines, typed into Terminal. The last one asks you a few questions so what you get is yours, then does the work.

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-crm-05-judgement-mac
cd outliers-crm-05-judgement-mac
python3 install.py
```

This layer needs Layers 1 to 4. There has to be something in your history for an assistant to read.

WHAT IT ASKS YOU, AND WHY

QUESTION	WHAT IT CHANGES
What makes someone a good fit for you, in your own words?	Written as you would say it out loud. The assistant is given your definition, not a generic one, so it is scoring for your business.
What would make you drop someone?	Just as useful as the positive version, and usually easier to answer honestly.

WHAT YOU END UP WITH

- A worked assistant with one job, whose instructions you can read and edit.
- The rule that everything written carries its source, applied automatically.
- A review list where anything uncertain waits for you instead of entering your records.

Now use it

10 minutes, and it will tell you something about your own contacts.

Let the assistant score the people in your CRM against the definition you gave it.

Then find one you disagree with, and read the reason it gave. One of 2 explanations is true: either it misread something, which tells you the instructions need a sentence adding, or it spotted something you had not, which is the whole reason you built it.

IF YOU ALREADY HAD SOMETHING LIKE THIS

Your test: take one fact your current assistant or tool has told you and try to find out where the information came from. If you cannot trace it back to a source, you do not know whether it is true.

WHAT THIS LAYER LEAVES UNSOLVED

You now have several assistants working, and any one of them could put a message in front of a real human being. Nothing is stopping 2 of them acting at once, or one of them checking its own work and passing it. That needs control which does not depend on them behaving well.

NEXT: LAYER 6 • ORDER AND SAFETY

Sequence, limits, and the rule that nothing reaches another person without your hand on it. Built into the machinery rather than written in the instructions.

WORDS USED IN THIS GUIDE

AI model	The kind of AI you type a question into and get an answer back from.
Assistant	Written instructions, plus one clearly defined job, plus a short list of actions it may take.
Tool	One specific action an assistant is allowed to take. Not an app.
Source	Where a fact came from, recorded next to the fact itself.
Review list	Where uncertain proposals wait for you, instead of being saved as true.
Staging	Where anything uncertain waits for you, instead of being saved as true.

What was run on a Mac

A **test Mac** is one of the Macs GitHub rents out by the minute to run a script.

Each line below is one this guide or the instructions file of the layer's download (README.md) gives you to type.

The run was on 2026-09-26. A script (a list of commands each test Mac carries out by itself) downloaded a fresh copy of the download from GitHub on each of 7 test Macs and ran each line below exactly as printed, in this order. After a `cd` line (`cd` moves Terminal into a folder), the lines that follow ran in that folder, as they do for you. The script ran them; no person typed them.

7 test runs: 3 on Macs set up from scratch (macOS 15.7.9 on Apple Silicon, macOS 15.7.9 on Intel, macOS 26.6.2 on Apple Silicon), and 4 on 2 Macs that also have Homebrew, an add-on installer many Mac owners use, each run once with Homebrew installed before Python and once after (macOS 15.7.9 on Apple Silicon and macOS 15.7.9 on Intel). Before the first line, the script put these on every Mac: Python from python.org; Node.js from nodejs.org, which this download does not use; Layers 1 to 4 of the CRM, installed from their Mac downloads. GitHub's Macs already have Apple's developer tools, which include git.

EACH LINE, THEN WHAT HAPPENED TO IT

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-crm-05-judgement-mac
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
cd outliers-crm-05-judgement-mac
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 install.py
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
cd ~/CRM
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 _engine/agent_check.py _agents/
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
cd ~/outliers-crm-05-judgement-mac
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 tests/test_agent_definitions.py
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 tests/test_provenance_and_staging.py
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

The script's record of the run is public, for anyone who wants to check it; you do not need to open it:

<https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-mac-test/actions/runs/36210563021>

NOT RUN ON THE TEST MACS

The box asking to install the developer tools cannot appear on a test Mac, because GitHub's Macs already have them.

The assistant itself. It runs inside Claude Code, which needs your own Claude Code login. The script ran the checker that reads its instructions file.